

TRUE TOADS

Distributed worldwide, the family Bufonidae is large and diverse. Its members are characterized by shortened forelimbs, hind limbs that are used for walking or hopping, dry warty skin, and parotoid glands behind the eyes. However, this family also includes the more slender and long-limbed South and Central American harlequin frogs and the stubfoot toads.



9–12 cm
3½–4¾ in

COMMON AFRICAN TOAD *Sclerophorus regularis*

Common in the whole of Africa except the driest parts of Sahara and Namib deserts, this thickset toad breeds in dams and ponds. Males produce rasping, duck-like calls to attract females.



5–11.5 cm
2–4½ in

MALAYAN TREE TOAD *Rentapia hosii*

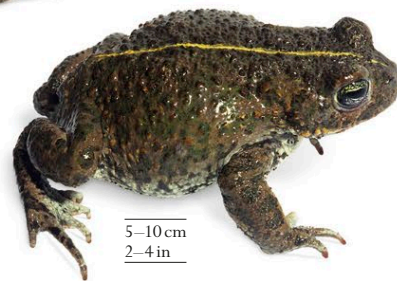
Found in E. Asia, this toad is unusual in living a largely arboreal life. It has adhesive pads on its toes that enable it to climb trees.



5–10 cm
2–4 in

GREEN TOAD *Bufo viridis*

A native of sandy habitats, this colourful toad is found in Europe and W. Asia. It emerges from its burrow in spring to breed in ponds.



5–10 cm
2–4 in

NATTERJACK *Epidalea calamita*

Compared with other true toads, this species has short legs and runs like a mouse. Occurring across Europe, it breeds from spring to summer.

CERATOBATRACHIDAE

Found in Southeast Asia, China, and several Pacific islands, frogs of this family produce large eggs that hatch directly into small frogs. In many species, the tips of the fingers and toes are enlarged.

FIJI GROUND FROG *Cornufer vitianus*

The populations of this species on several of the Fijian Islands have been wiped out following the introduction of mongooses.



2.5–11 cm
1–4¾ in

horn-like projection
above eye



flat,
triangular
head

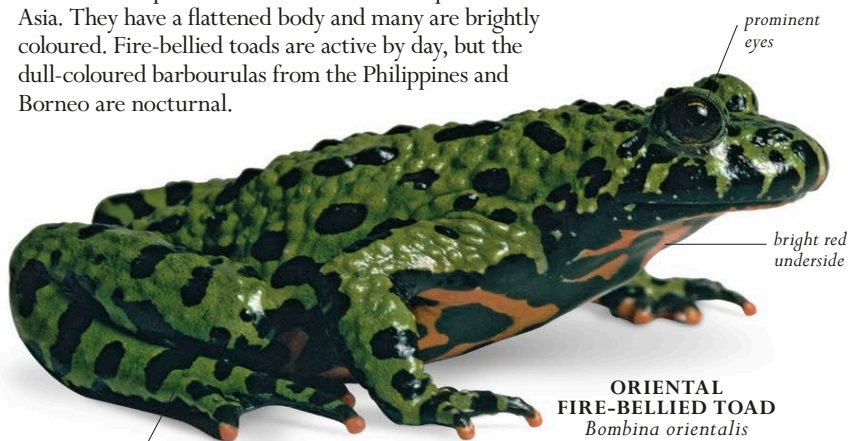
5–8 cm
2–3¼ in

SOLOMON ISLANDS HORNED FROG *Cornufer guentheri*

This species has a pointed snout and horn-like projections above its eyes. It hides among dead leaves.

BOMBINATORIDAE

These small aquatic toads are found in Europe and Asia. They have a flattened body and many are brightly coloured. Fire-bellied toads are active by day, but the dull-coloured barbourulas from the Philippines and Borneo are nocturnal.



bright green
coloration

prominent
eyes

bright red
underside

3–5 cm
1¼–2 in

ORIENTAL FIRE-BELLIED TOAD *Bombina orientalis*

Found in China and Korea, this small, squat frog can produce a toxic skin secretion. If attacked, it displays its bright belly colours.

RAIN FROGS

Members of the family Brevicipitidae are found in eastern and southern Africa. During mating, the much smaller male is glued onto a female's back by a special skin secretion.



3–5 cm
1¼–2 in

DESERT RAIN FROG *Breviceps macrops*

Living away from standing water, this burrowing frog lives and breeds among Namibian sand dunes, occasionally moistened by sea fog.